JAMES HARRISON

Frontend Engineer (Staff Level)

Edinburgh, United Kingdom

Email: james.harrison@gmail.com

Phone: +40 721 445 892

LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/jamesharrison-frontend

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Experienced Staff Frontend Engineer with 14 years of progressive experience building scalable user interfaces and leading frontend architecture decisions across fintech and e-commerce sectors. I specialise in React and TypeScript ecosystems, with a proven track record of mentoring junior engineers and delivering high-performance applications to millions of users. Based in Edinburgh, I'm passionate about clean code practices, accessibility standards, and creating seamless user experiences. I thrive in collaborative environments where technical excellence meets product vision.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

JavaScript, TypeScript, React, Redux, Vue.js, Angular, HTML5, CSS3, SASS, Webpack, Vite, Next.js, Jest, React Testing Library, Cypress, Figma, Git, Docker, AWS S3, Accessibility (WCAG), Web Performance Optimization, GraphQL, RESTful APIs, Agile Methodologies

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff Frontend Engineer

Synapse Data Ltd

Edinburgh, United Kingdom

March 2021 - Present

Architected and led the redesign of core customer dashboard serving 500,000+ monthly active users, resulting in 35% improvement in page load times and reducing bounce rate by 18%.

Mentored team of 5 junior and mid-level frontend engineers through code reviews, pair programming sessions, and structured learning initiatives, leading to 3 internal promotions within 18 months.

Established frontend testing standards and implemented comprehensive testing strategy across 12 microservices, increasing code coverage from 42% to 87% and reducing production bugs by 60%.

Spearheaded migration from AngularJS to React ecosystem, modernizing legacy codebase spanning 200,000+ lines of code while maintaining zero downtime and 99.9% application stability.

Senior Frontend Engineer

Sage Software Limited

Newcastle, United Kingdom

June 2017 - February 2021

Led development of multi-tenant SaaS platform built with React and TypeScript, supporting 15 enterprise clients across EMEA region with 99.95% uptime SLA.

Designed and implemented component library with 80+ reusable UI components, reducing development time for new features by 40% and ensuring consistent design language across 6 product teams.

Collaborated with UX/design team to conduct 12 user research sessions and implemented accessibility improvements achieving WCAG 2.1 AA compliance across entire platform.

Optimized bundle size by 45% through code splitting, tree shaking, and lazy loading strategies, improving Core Web Vitals scores and reducing customer support tickets related to performance.

Mid-level Frontend Engineer

BT Group

Manchester, United Kingdom

August 2010 - May 2017

Built responsive web applications using jQuery, Bootstrap, and later React, delivering features for customer self-service portal handling 2 million+ monthly transactions.

Partnered with backend teams to integrate REST and GraphQL APIs, implementing robust error handling and offline-first capabilities for mobile-responsive applications.

Participated in agile ceremonies and sprint planning, delivering an average of 8-12 story points per sprint while maintaining quality standards and meeting agreed deadlines.

Conducted technical presentations to stakeholders and non-technical team members, explaining frontend architecture decisions and justifying technology choices for 5 major platform upgrades.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Edinburgh

Edinburgh, United Kingdom

Graduated: June 2010

PROFESSIONAL CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate (2019)

Certified Accessibility Specialist (2022)